

[REDACTED]
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January 14, 1985

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Dear [REDACTED],

I suppose you've seen the followup article which appeared in the January issue of OMNI Magazine under the "Anti Matter" section. Once the cat is out of the bag, it keeps on mewing it seems!

[REDACTED] has sent me a package of his investigations which include two letters from you: one to him and one to a Peter Bons. I have read them with some fascination and not a little trepidation. They reveal a good deal more about that fateful piece of film than even I knew. It appears you did a good deal of analysis on it at the time.

I've pursued some research and investigation into the UFO phenomena ever since leaving the big blue womb of the Air Force. That incident seems to have set off an unquenchable thirst for more information about our possibly interstellar visitors. One of my more delightful encounters was with [REDACTED] n. At the time I was teaching at Cal State Humboldt. Fred was a professor of Physics there, having first been one of the developers of the hydrogen bomb. He retreated to teaching, much as I did, in a fit of conscience, hoping to do something more meaningful with his life. He had been an investigator and speaker on UFO's for several years when I met him. His files and our many conversations set me on the side of the "true believers" once and for all!

Unlike L [REDACTED], I am not a "buff". My research and thinking about the problem have been quiet and quite personal for the most part. The article in The Enquirer was originally intended for OMNI. It was written in a more articulate and academic tone. They rejected it, of course, as being "unsubstantiated". As a poor teacher in an impoverished state, I then sold it to The Enquirer to pay a few bills. I want you to know that I had no idea that it might prove quite so explosive, nor that it was quite as "real" as it turned out to be. The ridiculous style in which The Enquirer rewrote it is also quite an embarrassment to me! I also want you to know that, even after 17 years, I would never have written the piece had I known that it might still be "classified" somehow. It seemed pretty blase and even ridiculous to me at the time I wrote it, considering how much more meaningful "secrets" during my tenure in the service are now public knowledge.

I have followed the announcements and pronouncements by folks like C [REDACTED] with avid fascination. Between the lines, even in popular "fictions" like "E.T." and "Close Encounters of the Third Kind", one can certainly draw the conclusion that contact of SOME kind has taken place. The reports of McDermott and others of our astronauts are striking, especially in later retractions and denials of the "bogeys" and "UFO'S" in near space by public officials. The steady and continuing investigation of near space by our "friends" in the Soviet Union indicates more than a passing fancy on their parts, I think.

Therefore, I find interesting your comments on the relative beneficence of the U.S. versus the "wrong hands" people. As an American who, like you, has seen and experienced something of the last forty years, I would like to believe that we are "pro-mankind" and that any communications of higher technologies with concomitant improved destructive powers would be shared with us and no one else. We were, after all, at the end of WW II, the ONLY country with "the Bomb" and the ability to deliver it on target and at will. Had Stalin gotten that power, we would doubtless no longer be here to write letters or articles. If we were, we'd be speaking Russian! So, we were the first nation ever to have the sheer technical ability to conquer the planet and we did NOT do so. That's terrifically good for us as a people to have done, I suppose! Perhaps the recognition of our good will in rebuilding the war-torn Earth also counted in our favor.

Philosophically, however, I have to wonder at our arrogance in assuming that if contact from interstellar intelligence HAS taken place, that it has only taken place with us. The technology to which you and I were witness, the technology recorded on that few feet of film, indicates orders of magnitude from our relatively primitive efforts in ~~an~~ mechanics, propulsion and possibly quantum physics as well. Such intelligence might be suspected to regard us as little more than savages: ALL of us on this planet. I might even in my more retrospective moments, regard that beam of light..no, THOSE BEAMS of light on our film as a WARNING. A shot fired across the bow, so to speak, of our nuclear silliness ship. I have a true account, told me by another former Air Force guy of a VERY close encounter in 1957 at one of our SAC bases in the Atlantic. I'll relate it to you in person one day, I hope.

[REDACTED] m tells me that the Air Force now denies that there even existed a "telescope site" from which to shoot such film. You and I know it was there. I have a photo of us ^{at the site} smiling at the radio device I designed to send timing signals up there from Vandenberg. I got the Missile Insignia for that one. You and I also know that the same site exists today on Anderson Peak. From it we see the shuttle enter California airspace! The Air Force can ONLY deny things, it seems. And, like the Russians and the Nazis, when they deny the truth and then the truth comes out in public, how can they expect our citizens to have trust and confidence in the institutions we have erected to serve us?

Given that, as you put it to me at the time, "this never happened" [referring to the record of the UFO on film], it's not surprising that [REDACTED] can't get verification of it from the Air Force or the Freedom of Information Office. When Lee Graham tells me in a letter that you confirm the story but are "reluctant to make any inquiry...for fear of reprisal from the agency that appropriated the film", I shudder in my boots. I have an old, rusted, bent key. I picked it out of the dirt at Dachau. An historian friend of mine affirms that it was used to, most likely, to open the hot oven doors at that awful place which consumed so many of my people who were afraid of "reprisal" from their government. Over two decades after the filming of a "warning shot", must we still fear "reprisal" for seeking answers to what may be the innermost secrets of the cosmos itself?

I'm only a humble school teacher and alfalfa farmer in Wisconsin. I could disappear tonight. Only my fiance, my dog and a few close friends would notice. Because I am an American, I don't fear such "reprisal", however. Perhaps it is because I am a very naive American? Perhaps it's because our government has done such a very good job of making "nut-cases" out of anyone who reports a UFO that my credibility is shot and nobody cares what I say anymore.

Certainly there are a large number of "fringies"; true deluded or psychotic people who have climbed aboard the UFO bandwagon, claiming daily free rides to Venus and elsewhere to give their impotent lives some notoriety and meaning. The media have had a lot of fun propagating their stories at the expense of those of us who investigate in good faith and natural curiosity at a most peculiar and potentially exhilarating phenomenon or set of phenomena.

And all of this leads me to question; why all of this idiotic coverup? They are here, aren't they? We know it. The Russians know it. The South Africans and Pakistanis know it. Every kid in the third grade knows it. Reagan with his "Star Wars" nonsense knows it. So what's all the "fear of reprisal" business. Steven Spielberg told us all about it, for God's sake. Do we have to hear it at Disneyland?! Do guys like Lee Graham have to ferret out the truth to convince their buddies that they aren't nuts?

O.K. So, maybe we've found out a few trivial bits of this and that which might be useful in the national defense and deserve to be classified somehow. But where's the harm in letting everybody in ^{on} the great news that the universe is alive with other intelligence and that we are not bound for eternity all alone anymore? It's the best damned thing since Christmas and a few nurds in secret rooms don't deserve to keep it all to themselves.

It would be great fun to sit down with you sometime and talk and howl at the moon and the great spinning discs and faces on Mars and beyond. Maybe I'll be out your way this summer.

Best regards,

